

Diploma in

PHOTOSHOP



SUMMARY NOTES

Creating an Image Composite
Lesson 5

PHOTOSHOP IS RENOWNED FOR ITS ABILITY TO PUT MULTIPLE IMAGES TOGETHER, CUT SOMEONE OR SOMETHING OUT OF A BACKGROUND AND DROP THEM IN ANOTHER PICTURE, OR SIMPLY REMOVE AN UNWANTED OBJECT SEAMLESSLY. TO BEGIN TO DEVELOP THESE HUGELY CREATIVE AND PRACTICAL SKILLS, YOU NEED TO UNDERSTAND BOTH IMAGE LAYERS AND SELECTIONS. LESSON 6 WILL DEMONSTRATE HOW YOU CAN CREATE YOUR VERY OWN CREATIVE COMPOSITE, A PIECE OF ARTWORK TO BE PROUD OF.

5.01 What is Composition?

5.02 Tool Types

5.03 Select & Mask

5.04 Image Composite Tips

LESSON 5

WHAT IS COMPOSITION?

“When it Comes to Image Manipulation, the arrangement of elements in a scene can ultimately determine the difference between a good and a bad picture.”

Composition is one of the most fundamental elements in a photograph. Composition refers to the placement and relationship of elements within a picture. When it Comes to Image Manipulation, the arrangement of elements in a scene can ultimately determine the difference between a good and a bad picture.

Strong images and good communication rely on how you compose the image. Good composition thus relies on you to arrange the visual elements in your image in a way that guides the viewer’s eye and brings attention to your subject. In a well composed picture the subject will be apparent and clear. In a bad composition your eye will wander, searching to understand what the subject of the image is.

In Photoshop we need to understand layers and selections to create stunning composites. Unlike Photography, in which we a composite is a single still image, in Photoshop we use multiple images to create realistic looking composites.

The overall goal is to make the image look like all of the parts are from the one image or to be incredibly creative.

TOOL TYPES

Rectangular Marquee Tool allows us to select rectangles and squares.

Elliptical Marquee Tool allows us to select ellipses.

- To make a perfect circle hold down shift key while you click and drag.
- To draw ellipse out from the middle, click and hold alt/option key.

Lasso Tool is a free form drawing tool. It allows us to draw irregular shapes. Simple click and drag wherever you want the selection to go.

Polygonal Lasso Tool draws a point to point line around our subject. It can only draw straight lines.

- To delete a point, you can use the backspace key on your keyboard.

Magic Wand Tool is a very old tool. Nicknamed the 'tragic wand tool'. Uses contrast detection to make selections. Selects pixels similar in colour to the pixel on which you originally clicked on with the tool.

- *The Tolerance option tells Photoshop how different in tone and colour a pixel can be from the area we clicked on for it to be included in the selection. By default, the Tolerance value is set to 32, which means that Photoshop will select any pixels that are the same colour as the area we clicked on, plus any pixels that are up to 32 shades darker or 32 shades brighter.*
- *Contiguous: Only pixels connected to the spot by pixels of the same colour are selected.*

Quick Selection Tool allows us to quickly "paint" a selection using an adjustable round brush tip. As you drag, the selection expands outward and automatically finds and follows defined edges in the image.

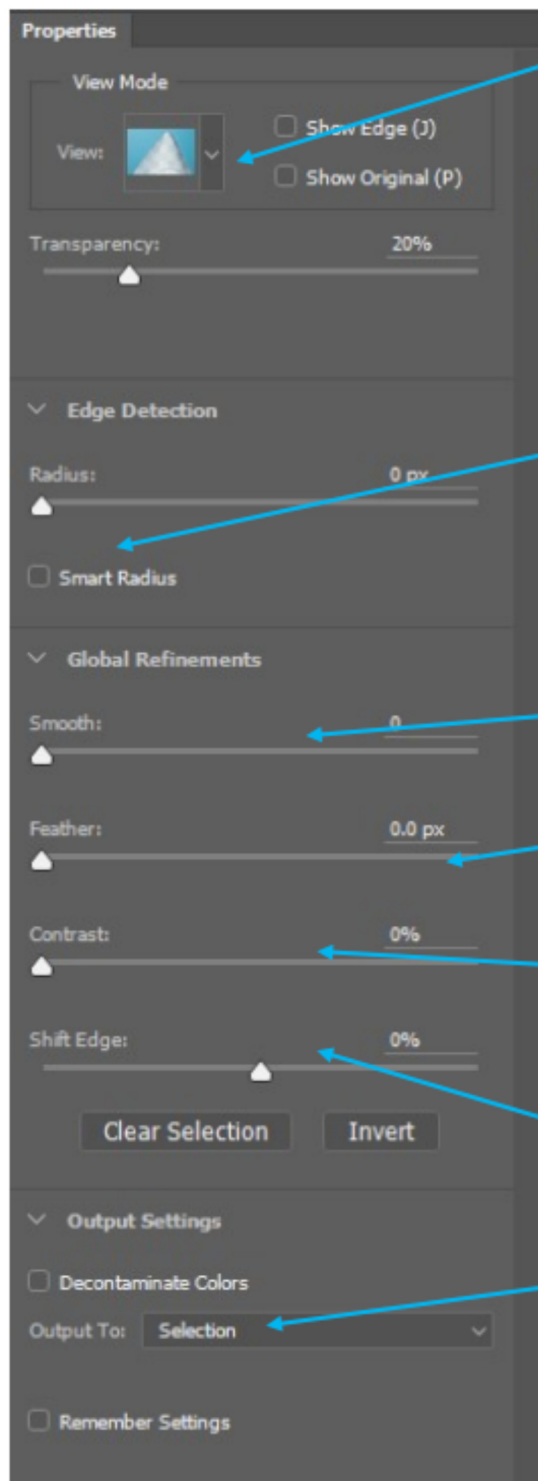
- *Tool uses contrast detection so sometimes doesn't work with blurred or low contrast images.*

All Tool Tips

- We can make our brush larger/smaller and harder/softer using the Options panel.
- We can use our square bracket keys as a shortcut to make brush larger/smaller.
- The Shift key allows us to add to the selection.
- The Alt/Option key will remove from the selection.
- Anti-Alias should be turned on for smoother selections.



SELECT & MASK



View Mode allows us to see our selected pixels in a variety of situations. Looking at your selections against both black and white are the most useful options here.

Smart Radius: By turning this setting on, Photoshop will decide whether the selection is hard or soft using an intelligent edge detection algorithm. You can then play with the **Radius** slider until the edges look natural.

Smooth: Makes the selection edges smoother if they are jagged.

Feather: Feathering makes the edges of our selections softer by using partially transparent or differently coloured pixels.

Contrast: This setting sharpens your edge even if you soften it by using Feather or smoothen it by using Smooth.

Shift Edge: This setting shifts your edge. It can either contract your selection or expand your selection.

When outputting using the method shown in Lesson 4, make sure you choose **Selection**.

Step-by-Step Guide to making an Image Composite



ORIGINAL

SELECT & MASK



IMAGE COMPOSITION TIPS

1. Refine your selection using the 'Select and Mask' option. This will make the cut out look more realistic.
2. To cut the object out from the background there are two routes you can take.
 - A. Edit > Copy and Edit Paste
 - B. Or Layer > New > Layer Via Copy
3. Select desired background from another image using appropriate selection tool and Edit > Copy. Paste this background directly underneath the new layer that you just created which contains the cut out object.
4. If you need to resize the object you have pasted into Photoshop, simple go Edit > Free Transform to scale the image. Holding shift will constrain proportions.
5. Use Adjustment Layers to make the two layers sit in well together. You need to make it look realistic so look at contrast and colour differences between the two sources images. You can Use a Clipping Mask if you like so that your Adjustment is clipped to a single layer as opposed to the entire stack.
6. You can paint in shadows using the brush tool at a soft setting and with the layer on low opacity.
7. To preserve the document with layers intact, save as PSD.
8. Decide which Selection Tool will be most appropriate for the job.
9. Select the Object that you want to cut out. If it is easier, you can select everything but the object and then invert the section (Select > Inverse).

Note: A clipping mask allows us to clip or tie a specific adjustment layer to a specific pixel layer. This is useful when we are making image composites as sometimes you will want to work with individual layers as opposed to the entire stack of layers. To add a clipping mask you can use the Clipping Mask icon inside the Adjustment Layers Property panel.





THANK YOU